"Priyanka quickly digs deep into the character and creates a wonderful rhythmic balance with co-actors"

SATYAVRAT RAUT
Theatre director



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

Hair: Amit Thakur, Styled By: Devki Bhatt, Make Up: Niti Goenka

"Half the industry is driven by conventions of what is good and bad. I have made a career out of [playing] grey [characters]"

STAGE CRAFT

PRIYANKA SHARMA, 35

Theatreperson

Born and brought up in an old Delhi business family, theatre actor and director Priyanka Sharma has created a special space for herself on the Indian stage. Though she's not a National School of Drama graduate, her adaptability to roles was key 4-5 years back when theatre director Satyavrat Raut was desperately looking for an actress for his critically acclaimed play *Tumhara Vincent* as his lead had left for Mumbai. Priyanka rescued the situation by preparing for the role in just 15 days. One of her directorial efforts, *Dhruv Swamini*, attracted an audience on the sheer strength of her performance.

The theatre activist, now a veteran of over 600 shows, has worked for social organisations like Smile, CRY and AISA and also runs her own theatre group, Silly Souls, in Delhi's Civil Lines. As she says, "We have to create such cultural spaces where people can entertain themselves in a creative way, it's the only way society will progress." Her next project is a new play, 'The Last Man', based on Orwell's novel *1984*. ■

–Sheokesh Mishra

HALLOWED HALLS Priyanka tried out for NSD in 2007, but didn't get through. She did get to do a four-day workshop there, though, which she enjoyed.